

Make 11 - Kian Rich

2. When it came to research I used two separate news sources to help me figure out how much carbon dioxide has been released into the atmosphere by Chat-GPT. I then used two separate calculators, one to determine the amount of carbon dioxide released, by a trip in a plane from one place to the other, the second calculator to determine how many trees would need to be planted and grow to offset the amount of Carbon released. The hardest information to find was how much carbon was released in a single prompt, message, or question to the AI, and figuring out a good calculator to use to find out how much carbon dioxide is released or how much is taken in. There are a few uncertainties in the calculations. There is a range for the number of trees for example that are needed to take in the carbon dioxide to offset it, because it's a range it does leave much to be left to speculation.

3. Sustainability Page:

1. From what I've found about ethics in regard to AI data centers and AI companies, I've come across that for the most part they are grossly unethical, with them outsourcing labor like data labeling, and mining companies for cheap. Along with the mass amounts of carbon they produce just in training, and with that training it often involves subjecting other people to see some of the most depraved things that exist on the internet, in writing or otherwise, while still paying them not even a reasonable wage, without reasonable compensation, and long hours of this.

2.

<https://www.forbes.com/sites/dianneplummer/2025/08/28/ai-training-fuels-massive-carbon-costs-and-demands-greener-solutions/>

<https://www.theguardian.com/technology/2025/sep/11/google-gemini-ai-training-humans#:~:text=AI%20raters%3A%20the%20shadow%20workforce,generalist%20raters%20and%20super%20raters.>

<https://crossdockinsights.com/p/critical-minerals-powering-data-centers>

3. I have made attempts to only use AI on my own, when it is absolutely necessary or I need the assistance of it, and I do attempt to avoid using it when possible even in this class, however I estimate that I have produced around 200 grams of CO2 at least, from the amount of conversations I have had with AI's. I do look forward to being better and using AI less in the future, and only as a last resort and once I am fully certain I have exhausted all other options of figuring something out. However I won't pretend I am fully capable of avoiding AI's, as things like algorithms and AI's that companies push onto us as consumers are things I can't avoid or stop from happening.

4. As individuals, it's up to us to decide how we actually utilize AI, the best way to utilize it in my opinion is at least right now to use it as a starting point, and a guiding hand, but never as a work around or a way out of something you just don't want to do. On a systemic level, there

need to be limitations set on these companies, and checks that these data centers aren't complete detriments to nature, or people. The people responsible for how AI is utilized is on us as people, It's our decision to use them on a daily basis, however it is the role of companies to make sure these AI's are being responsible, and aren't just being used for a trend, or as a cash grab.

4. My biggest concern from this research is the sheer environmental cost taken by only training AI's. I was genuinely shocked to learn that 552 tons were released in the training of Chat-GPT version 3. It is incredibly worrying to think about that and know this is probably the case for every AI being developed and updated, not just Chat-GPT. I would like to believe that it will be possible at some point for AI to be environmentally friendly and sustainable, however I won't deny the likelihood of it in my opinion is low. Not just because it would take time to research that kind of thing and so it would take a while till we'd know how, but also because from all I've seen about these companies, they're more focused on making as much money as possible with hardly any true regard for the consequences. The best we can do right now is spread the information about the consequences of these AI data centers and companies, and for us to be decisive with how we use AI's and the frequency in which we use them.